

LIEN VU

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Adjunct Faculty/Instructor Of Record (Johns Hopkins University)

Learning Sciences Studios: Theory, Analysis, and Ed Tech Design

Fall 2026

Explorations in Mind, Brain, and Teaching

Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant (University of Delaware)

Research Methods

Spring 2025

Perception and Sensation

Fall 2024

A Multidisciplinary Introduction to Disability Studies

Fall 2023, Spring 2024

Research Assistant (University of Delaware)

Knowledge Brokering: CREATED

2025-2026

Investigating the neurobiological changes resulting from a reading or mathematics intervention

2023-present

Principal and School Policy Analysis

2022-2023

Examining Motivational Constructs in Computational Thinking
for Preservice Teacher Development.

2021-2022

EDUCATION

University of Delaware

2027

Ph.D., Educational Statistics and Research Methods with a Certificate in Program Evaluation

Advisors: Dr. Henry May and Dr. Stephanie Del Tufo

Dissertation Title:

Kumon and the Developing Mind: A Three-Part Study of Learning, Achievement, and Brain Change

Johns Hopkins University

2011

M.S., Educational Studies with certificates in Mind, Brain, Teaching and Gifted Education

University of Rochester

1998

B.A., Double Major in Economics and Health and Society (Cum Laude)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Certified Instructor, Director and Owner, Kumon Math and Reading Center,

Willow Grove/Hatboro and Elkins Park, PA

2006-Present

Senior Business Analyst,

Marketing Analysis, Advanta Corp.,

Spring House, PA

2001-2005

Consultant,

Management Consulting Services, PricewaterhouseCoopers LLP,

Rosslyn, VA

2000-2001

Assistant to the Director,

Division of International Finance,

Federal Reserve Board of Governors,

Washington, D.C.

1999-2000

Recipient of the 2000 Annual Cash Award for outstanding service.

Research Assistant,

Division of Research and Statistics,

Federal Reserve Board of Governors,

Washington, D.C.

1998-1999

GRANTS

Co-Investigator and Graduate Researcher, Exploring the Relationship Between Dosage, Working Memory, and Home Environment Factors After a Math and Reading Intervention
University of Delaware Research Foundation - Strategic Initiative Grant

HONORS AND AWARDS

Doctoral Fellowship for Excellence, University of Delaware	2026
First Place Graduate Paper, Steel Symposium, University of Delaware	2024
Delegate of the Kakehashi Project, Asian Pacific American Institute for Congressional Studies	2023
Graduate Student Travel Award, University of Delaware	2021
Participant of AERA Institute on Statistical Analysis for Education Policy on Causal Analysis Using International Data, part of the AERA Grants Program	2014
School of Education Scholarship, Johns Hopkins University	2010
Charles E. Phelps Scholar, University of Rochester	1998
Senior Scholar, University of Rochester	1998
Barth-Crapsey Undergraduate Research Award, University of Rochester	1997
Reach for Rochester Community Service Scholarship, University of Rochester	1996
Howard Hughes Summer Research Fellowship, University of Rochester	1995
Ronald E. McNair Post-Baccalaureate Achievement Scholar, University of Rochester	1994
Bausch and Lomb Scholarship, University of Rochester	1994

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

3. Patt., R., Veng S., **Vu., L.**, Shen., C.C., Mouza., C. (2025) "It's More Like Recess and Cool": Teaching Elementary Students Cybersecurity with a Social Robot. *Journal of Interactive Learning Research*, 36(4), 369-396. <https://doi.org/10.70725/722215oqzsne>
2. Blinkoff, E., Wright, C.A., Scott, M., Fletcher, K., Masters, A.S., Ilgaz, H., **Vu, L.**, Hirsh-Pasek, K., and Golinkoff, R. M. (2023). Shifting from a classroom of reluctant compliance to a classroom of responsive curiosity. *Young Children*, 78(3), 14-22. <https://www.naeyc.org/resources/pubs/yc/fall2023>
1. Dore. R.A., Hassinger-Das, B., Brezack, N., Valladares, T.L., Paller, A., **Vu, L.**, Golinkoff, R.M., and Hirsh-Pasek, K. (2018). The parent advantage in fostering children's e-book comprehension. *Early Childhood Research Quarterly*, 44, 24-33. doi: 10.1016/j.ecresq.2018.02.002

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

2. **Vu, L.** (*in preparation*). Evaluation of the Impacts of an After-School Program Using Propensity Score Methods.
1. **Vu, L.**, Student, S., Houang, R., and Del Tufo, S. (*in preparation*). Does extra mathematical practice help students overcome barriers associated with understanding mathematical word problems?

PROCEEDINGS PAPERS, REPORTS, AND BOOK CHAPTERS

5. **Vu, L.**, Mouza, C., and Garvin, M. (2024). Examining motivational constructs in computational thinking for preservice teacher development. In D. C. Gibson, M. N. Ochoa, and Y. Jin (Eds.), *Research highlights in technology and teacher education 2023* (pp. 65-72). Association for the Advancement of Computing in Education (AACE). <https://www.learntechlib.org/primary/p/223858/>.
4. **Vu, L.**, Mouza, C. and Garvin, M. (2023). Examining Motivational Constructs in Computational Thinking for Preservice Teacher Development. In E. Langran, P. Christensen and J. Sanson (Eds.), *Proceedings of Society for Information Technology and Teacher Education International Conference* (pp. 106-112). New Orleans, LA, United States: Association for the Advancement of Computing in Education (AACE). <https://www.learntechlib.org/primary/p/221857/>.

3. **Vu, L.**, Alkhateeb, B., Garvin, M. and Mouza, C. (2022). Using Word Clouds to Uncover Preservice Teachers' Understanding of Computational Thinking in the Context of Teacher Education Coursework. In E. Langran (Ed.), *Proceedings of Society for Information Technology and Teacher Education International Conference* (pp. 2138-2146). San Diego, CA, United States: Association for the Advancement of Computing in Education (AACE). <https://www.learntechlib.org/primary/p/221004/>.

2. Bower, C., **Vu, L.**, Golinkoff, R. M., and Hirsh-Pasek, K. (2019, July 12). School's out: Block out time for spatial learning. *Brookings Institution*. <https://www.brookings.edu/blog/education-plus-development/2019/07/09/schools-out-block-out-time-for-spatial-learning/>

1. Byrnes, J.P., **Vu, L.** Educational Neuroscience: Definitional, Methodological, and Interpretive Issues, *WIREs Cognitive Science*, 2015.

INVITED TALKS

Title: Exploring the Relationship Between Dosage and Working Memory

Date: March 2026

Forum: Education and Brain Sciences Research Lab (EBRL)

Location: Peabody College of Education at Vanderbilt University, Nashville, Tennessee.

NATIONAL AND INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

6. **Vu, L.**, May, H., Houang, R., Del Tufo, S.N. (2025, July 16-19). *Kumon: let's read for fun!* [Conference Poster]. Society for the Scientific Study of Reading (SSSR), Calgary, Canada.

5. Lawrence, J., **Vu, L.**, Henderson, A., Chavers, A., Del Tufo, S.N. (2025, July 16-19). *Computer-assisted intervention impact on reading outcomes in children with reading disabilities*. [Conference Poster]. Society for the Scientific Study of Reading (SSSR), Calgary, Canada.

4. **Vu, L.**, Student, M. (2025, April 23-26). *An Item-Level Investigation of the Impact of Kumon*. [Conference Poster]. National Council on Measurement in Education (NCME), Denver, Colorado, United States.

3. **Vu, L.**, Houang, R., May, H., Ran., F. (2024, April 11-14). *Evaluation of the Impacts of Kumon Using Propensity Score Matching*. [Conference Poster]. American Educational Research Association (AERA), Philadelphia, Pennsylvania.

2. **Vu, L.**, Preston, M., Delgado, A., Patt, R., Golinkoff, G. (2023, March 23-25). *An International Study on Children's and Adults' Perception of Play*. [Conference Poster]. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Salt Lake City, Utah.

1. **Vu, L.**, Bower, C., Evans, N., Zimmermann, L., Verdine, B., Toub, T. S., Foster, L., Islam, S., Golinkoff, R. M., Hirsh-Pasek, K. (2019, March 21-23). *Growth curve modeling of preschoolers' spatial skills during spatial training*. [Conference Poster]. Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD), Baltimore, Maryland.

OTHER PRESENTATIONS

3. **Vu, L.**, Houang, R., May, H., Ran., F. (2024, April 19). *Evaluation of the Impacts of Kumon Using Propensity Score Matching*. [Paper Presentation - 1st place winner]. 39th Annual Marion H. Steele Research Symposium, Newark, DE, United States.

2. **Vu, L.**, An International Comparison of Health Care Policy for Asian Ethnic Minorities, *National Conferences on Undergraduate Research Proceedings*, (1998, April 23-25). [Paper Presentation]. 12th National Undergraduate Research Conference, Salisbury, Maryland.

1. **Vu, L.**, An International Comparison of Health Care Policy for Asian Ethnic Minorities, *McNair Research Journal*, 1998. [Paper Presentation] Ronald E. McNair Research Conference and Barth-Crapsey Research Conference, Rochester, New York.

MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Research Mentees

3. Andromeda Henderson, University of Delaware
2. Jada Lawrence, University of Delaware
1. Brianna Deklavon, University of Delaware

Mentee Presentations

5. Henderson, A., and Del Tufo, S.N. (2025, September 12-14). *Emotional regulation in individuals with developmental dyslexia*. [Poster presentation]. Society for the Neurobiology of Language (SNL) 17th Annual Meeting, Washington, DC., United States.
4. Deklavon, B. (2025, April 24). *Self-Report of a Specific Learning Disability Differs by Race*. [Poster presentation]. College of Education and Human Development's Steele Symposium at the University of Delaware, Newark, Delaware, USA.
3. Henderson, A. (2025, April 24). *Emotional regulation in individuals with reading difficulties: A preliminary investigation*. [Poster presentation]. College of Education and Human Development's Steele Symposium at the University of Delaware, Newark, Delaware, USA.
2. Lawrence, J. (2025, April 24). *What is the role of computer-assisted intervention on reading comprehension in children with reading disabilities*. [Poster presentation]. College of Education and Human Development's Steele Symposium at the University of Delaware, Newark, Delaware, USA.
1. Lawrence, J., **Vu, L.**, Henderson, A., Chavers, A., Del Tufo, S.N., (2025, July 16-19). *Computer-assisted intervention impact on reading outcomes in children with reading disabilities*. [Poster presentation]. Scientific Study of Reading (SSSR) 32nd Annual Meeting, Calgary, Canada.

Mentee Awards and Achievements

2. Andromeda Henderson,
Elisha Conover Scholarship, 2025
Beinecke Scholarship Nominee, 2025
Psi Chi, The International Honor Society for Psychology Students, 2025
1. Jada Lawrence, School Psychology, Master of Arts, University of Delaware, 2025

SERVICE TO THE FIELD

Volunteer, President, Organization of Chinese Americans – Greater Philadelphia, Convention Chair, Philadelphia, PA, 2005-2008, 2013-2025 Founded in 1973, OCA is a national organization dedicated to advancing the social, political, and economic well-being of Asian Pacific Americans in the United States.

Accreditation Reviewer, Member, Middle States Association, Pennsylvania, 2025 Make objective observations and conclusions based on evidence presented. Participate in intensive work sessions and cooperate with other team members in meeting the expectations of the team.

Manuscript Reviewer:

Literacy Research: Theory, Method, and Practice, Vol. 75 (2026)
Emerging Adulthood (2025)

Conference Reviewer: American Psychological Association Conference (2026)

ADDITIONAL METHODOLOGICAL TRAINING

4. Matching Methods for Multilevel Data in Education Research at SREE Baltimore (2026)
3. AFNI Bootcamp (fMRI analysis using the AFNI toolset) in Philadelphia (2026)
2. Planning and Analysis of Multisite and Cluster Randomized Trials with Instructors: Luke Miratrix, Harvard University, and Michael Weiss, MDRC at the SREE Annual Conference (2025)
1. Advanced Meta-Analysis at the AERA Annual Meeting (2024)

ANALYTICAL SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

Data Collection Tools: REDCAP and Qualtrics
Data Analysis Tools: RStudio, HLM 7, Dedoose, SAS, JASP, JAGS, STAN, STATA, MPlus
Neuro-imaging Tools: SPM12/MATLAB, FSL (w/FMRIB's Expert Analysis Tool)
Programming Languages: R, Python (Google Colab)

COURSEWORK

Qualitative Research	Regression and Structural Equation Modeling	Intro to fMRI
Applied Multivariate Data Analysis	Mixed Methods in Social Science Research	Program Evaluation
Multilevel Models	Randomized Field Trials	Survey Design
Educational Data Mining	Design of Learning Environments	Bayesian Statistics
Responsible Conduct Research	Disciplinary Knowledge/Learning Sciences	Data Visualization
Secondary Data for Decision Making	Advanced Structural Equation Modeling	Intelligence Testing
Computational Neuroscience	Educational Measurement Theory	fMRI Motor

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Educational Research Association (AERA)	Since 2015
SIGs: Out-of-School Time, Research on Evaluation, Giftedness	Since 2021
National Council on Measurement in Education (NCME)	Since 2024
National Association for Gifted Children, Research and Evaluation Committee	Since 2023
Pennsylvania Association for Gifted Education (PAGE)	Since 2010
Society for the Scientific Study of Reading (SSSR)	Since 2025
Society for Research in Child Development (SRCD)	Since 2020
Women in Cognitive Science (WiCS+)	Since 2025
Middle States Association Member and Volunteer	Since 2010

REFERENCES

1. Henry May, Ph.D.
Professor of Educational Statistics and Research Methods
Director of the Center for Research and Education and Social Policy
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Center for Research and Education and Social Policy
Pearson Hall, 125 Academy Street, Newark, DE 19716 University of Delaware
Email: hmay@udel.edu

2. Stephanie N. Del Tufo, Ph.D.
Assistant Professor
Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences
Interdisciplinary Neuroscience Graduate (ING) Program
● Contact Information College of Education and Human Development
16 W. Main Street, Newark, DE 19716
University of Delaware
Email: sdeltufo@udel.edu

3. Chrystalla Mouza, Ed.D.
Dean, College of Education
Edward William and Jane Marr Gutsell Professor, Curriculum and Instruction
Professor, Curriculum and Instruction
● Contact Information
University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign
0038E Education
357 Education Building (mail code 708)
Champaign (UIUC Campus Mail), IL 61820
Email: cmouza@illinois.edu